Pablo Villar-Abeijón

pablo.villar@uab.cat

1. RESEARCH INTERESTS

Gentrification; Socio-spatial inequalities; Housing affordability; Urban segregation; Quantitative socio-spatial analysis; Urban policy; Mobility; Sustainable urban transformations.

2. CURRENT POSITION

Doctoral Researcher (FI Joan Oró Fellowship) at Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (2024–present). PhD research on gentrification, neighbourhood change and housing affordability, examining the unintended effects of urban interventions through quantitative spatial analysis and quasi-experimental methods.

3. EDUCATION

2024 - 2027	**Ph.D. in Geography**
	University: Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain)
	Supervisors: Oriol **Marquet**; Carme **Miralles-Guasch**
	Thesis title: Proximity-Driven Gentrification: The Unintended Effects of Active Mobility Infrastructure on Population, Commercial and Housing Shifts.
2022 - 2023	**MA in Territorial Studies and Planning**
	University: Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain)
2018 - 2022	**BA in Political Science and Public Administration**
	University: Universidade de Santiago de Compostela (Spain)
	Extraordinary End-of-Degree Award (Ranked 1st in the graduating class)
	Erasmus exchange year: **Sciences Po Lyon** – Certificat d'Études Politiques.

4. RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Research methods	Quantitative urban analysis; quasi-experimental methods; neighbourhood change analysis.
Spatial analysis	Spatial statistics; geospatial visualization; GIS-based urban analysis.
Software	R, Stata, SPSS, QGIS, ArcGIS Pro, GeoDa.

Pablo Villar-Abeijón
September 2026

pablo.villar@uab.cat
ORCID: 0009-0007-6111-2638

5. VISITING POSITIONS

Fall 2025 Visiting Fellow, **Université de Montréal** (Canada), Centre de Recherche en Santé Publique (CReSP).

6. ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2023 - 2024 **Research Support Specialist**
Geography Department, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (Spain).

Spatial data analysis and research support in urban and transport geography projects.

7. PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Villar-Abeijón, P. & Rodríguez-Barcón, A. (2026). Xentrificación na Galicia urbana: unha proposta metodolóxica para cidades medianas aplicada á Coruña, Santiago de Compostela e Vigo. *Scripta Nova. Revista Electrónica de Geografía y Ciencias Sociales.* 30(3). doi: 10.1344/sn2026.30.53466. **Q3 in Geography, Planning and Development (SJR)**

Mombelli, S., Cubells, J., **Villar-Abeijón, P.**, & Marquet, O. (2026). Media framing and political discourse of Barcelona's urban transformations (2016–2024). *Cities*, 179, 107443. doi: 10.1016/j.cities.2026.107443. **Q1/D1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

Villar Abeijón, P., Fernández Núñez, M. B., & Marquet, O. (2026). Perceived vs. objective gentrification: Bridging measurements of neighborhood change. *Journal of Urban Affairs*, 1–26. doi: 10.1080/07352166.2026.2638887. **Q1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

Villar Abeijón, P., Miralles-Guasch, C., & Marquet, O. (2026). The effects of pedestrianization on commercial dynamics a quasi-experimental study in Barcelona. *Applied Geography*, 189, 103947. doi: 10.1016/j.apgeog.2026.103947. **Q1/D1 in Geography, Planning and Development (SJR).**

Villar Abeijón, P., Miralles-Guasch, C., & Marquet, O. (2026). The impact of proximity to amenities on housing affordability: Insights from Mediterranean 15-minute cities. *Cities*, 172, 106859. doi: 10.1016/j.cities.2026.106859. **Q1/D1 in Urban Studies (SJR).**

Villar Abeijón, P., Miralles Guasch, C., & Marquet Sardà, O. (2025). Can pedestrianization trigger gentrification? *Transportation Research Part D: Transport and Environment*, 142, 104718. doi: 10.1016/j.trd.2025.104718. **Q1/D1 in Transportation (SJR).**

8. PARTICIPATION IN FUNDED RESEARCH PROJECTS

2024 - 2028	**European Commission (ERC Starting Grant)**; *ATRAPA: The active travel backlash paradox: opposition and acceptability determinants of built environment-based sustainable travel interventions*. Type of participation: **researcher** (1,500,000€).
2026 - 2028	**Ministry of Science and Innovation (Spain)**; *FUTURBAN: Mapeando el Futuro: Herramientas Interactivas para la Planificación Urbana Prospectiva*. Type of participation: **research collaborator** (242,000€).
2022 - 2024	**Ministry of Science and Innovation (Spain)**; *MOVACT 1.0 – Territorios para la movilidad activa en España. Desarrollo del Atlas MOVACT 1.0.* Proyectos de I+D+i – Pruebas de Concepto. Type of participation: **contracted research assistant** (175,000€).

9. TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026	*Geographical Visions of the World* (Teaching assistant) Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona. (Spain) Delivered **lectures and practical classes**.
2025	*Urban Policies: Housing, Neighborhoods and Transport* (Teaching assistant) Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona. (Spain) Delivered **practical classes**.

10. CONFERENCES' PRESENTATIONS

2026	XIX Coloquio Ibérico de Geografía, Lugo (Spain).
2026	World Planning Schools Congress (**WPSC**) 2026, Helsinki (Finland).
2025	Association of European Schools of Planning (**AESOP**) Annual Congress, Istanbul (Türkiye).
2025	European Network for Housing Research (**ENHR**), Grand Paris (France).
2024	Association of European Schools of Planning (**AESOP**) Annual Congress, Paris (France).
2024	Urban Transitions, Sitges (Spain).
2024	International Conference Association of People-Environment Studies (IAPS), Barcelona (Spain).

11. LANGUAGES

Spanish:	Native
Galician:	Native
English:	Full professional proficiency (C2)

French: Full professional proficiency (C2)
Catalan: Full professional proficiency (C1)

12. SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS AND AWARDS

2024 PhD Joan Oró Fellowship (FI-AGAUR), Catalan Government (Spain).

2022 End-of-Degree Excellence Award (*Premio Fin de Carreira*), Galician Government (Spain).

13. SELECTED ADDITIONAL TRAINING

2026 ***World Planning Schools Congress – PhD Workshop***. Tampere University (Finland). Duration: 80 hours.

2025 ***Demography of Catalonia***. Centre for Demographic Studies (CED), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona & Government of Catalonia (Spain). Duration: 8 hours.

2024 ***Geographic Information Systems in Applied Economics***. Fiscal Studies Institute (Spain). Duration: 20 hours.

2024 ***Advanced Course in Geographic Information Systems*** *(ArcGIS Pro*). National Geographic Institute (IGN), Ministry of Transport and Sustainable Mobility (Spain). Duration: 40 hours.

14. SUPERVISION EXPERIENCE

2026 **Master's Thesis.** *Commercial Gentrification: A Qualitative Analysis of Aesthetic Markers in Pedestrianized and Non-Pedestrianized Streets in Barcelona.* **Raquel Torres Aponte**. Co-supervised with Oriol Marquet.

MA in Interdisciplinary Studies in Environmental, Economic and Social Sustainability. Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (UAB).

15. PEER REVIEW ACTIVITY

Journal reviewer

Cities & Health. Elsevier (1)

Spatial Demography. Springer Nature (1)

Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy. Springer Nature (1)

Discover Cities. Springer Nature (1)